are connected together. It is supported, and its back part is formed by the middle, or dorsal, region of the spine. It is narrow above, broad below, flattened before and behind, and somewhat cordiform on a transverse section.

The superior opening of the thorax is bounded on each side by the first rib; in front, by the upper border of the sternum; and behind, by the first dorsal vertebra. It is broader from side to side than from before backward; and its direction is backward and upward.

The lower opening, or base, is bounded in front by the ensiform cartilage; behind, by the last dorsal vertebra; and on each side of the last rib, the diaphragm fills the intervening space. Its direction is obliquely downward and backward, so that the cavity of the thorax is much deeper on the posterior than on the anterior wall. It is wider transversely than from before backward. Its outer surface is convex; but it is more flattened at the centre than at the sides. Its floor is higher on the right than on the left side, corresponding to the upper border of the fifth costal cartilage on the right side; and to the corresponding part of the sixth cartilage on the left side.

The parts which pass through the upper opening of the thorax are, from before backward, the sterno-hyoid and the sterno-thyroid muscles, the remains of the thymus gland, the trachea, œsophagus, thoracic duct, and the longus colli muscles on each side; on the sides, the arteria innominata, the left carotid and left subclavian arteries, the internal mammary and